



HA LONG BAY
 A Vietnamese legend tells of a gigantic dragon that thrashed its way into the sea, smashing the limestone coastline into thousands of islands and rocky outcrops. Today, Ha Long Bay, which means “where the dragon descends into the sea,” has some of the most dramatic scenery in this region. It has inspired many poets and painters.

PINEAPPLES
 Thailand is the world's leading producer of pineapples, but this fruit is grown in many parts of southeast Asia. Much of the crop is canned and exported.



BIRDS' NEST SOUP
 The brown-rumped swift builds its nest high in the roofs of caves throughout Southeast Asia. Local men risk death climbing flimsy ladders to collect these nests, which form the main ingredient of birds' nest soup. The nests are made from the birds' saliva, but when they are plucked in boiling water they look like noodles.